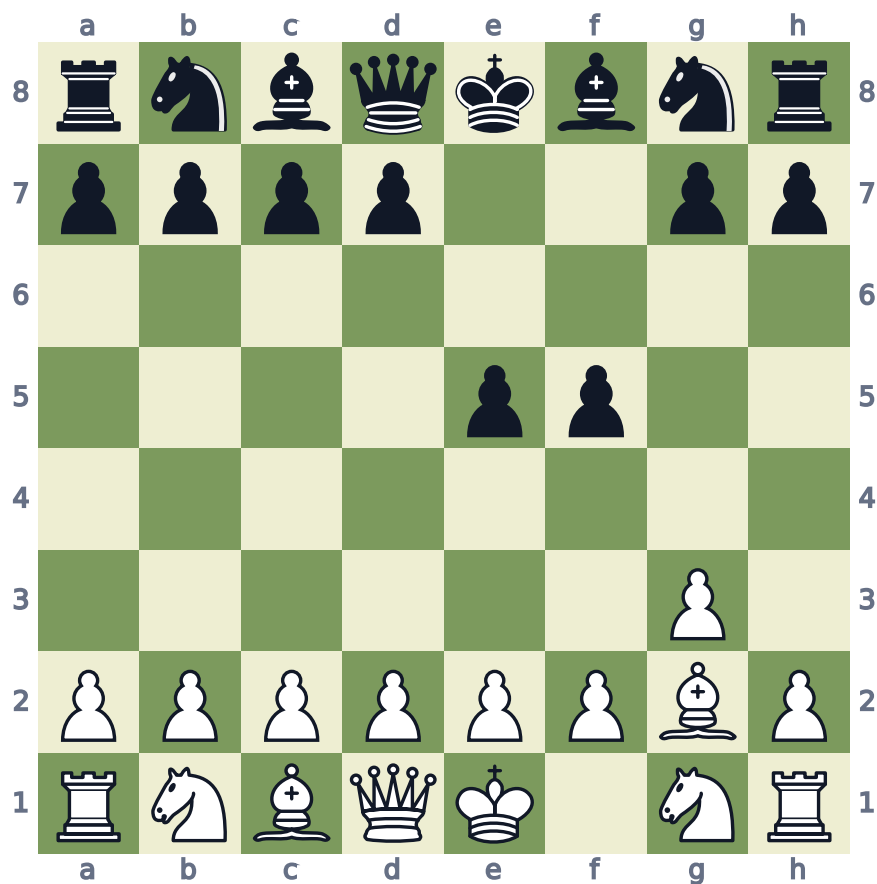


White Hippo Tactics, Traps, and Defensive Resources

Long-diagonal tactics, central breakthroughs, king safety, and tactical exits



Train the forcing decisions hidden inside White-Hippo positions and learn when a strategic rule must yield to calculation.

36 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Train the forcing decisions hidden inside White-Hippo positions and learn when a strategic rule must yield to calculation.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 36 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The a1-h8 diagonal must be checked before b3 or c-pawn moves.

PRINCIPLE 2

A center break may attack a piece by opening a bishop or rook line.

PRINCIPLE 3

Pinned defenders may make a natural recapture impossible.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

A compact position can collapse when one file opens.

PRINCIPLE 5

King safety changes immediately after f4 or h4.

PRINCIPLE 6

Calculate checks, captures, and threats before applying a setup rule.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

TACTICAL PROTOCOL

How to solve opening tactics without guessing

STEP 1

Update the board after the last move: new attacks, lost defenses, and opened lines.

STEP 2

List every legal check, major capture, and direct threat for both sides.

STEP 3

Identify loose pieces, pinned defenders, overloaded pieces, and exposed kings.

STEP 4

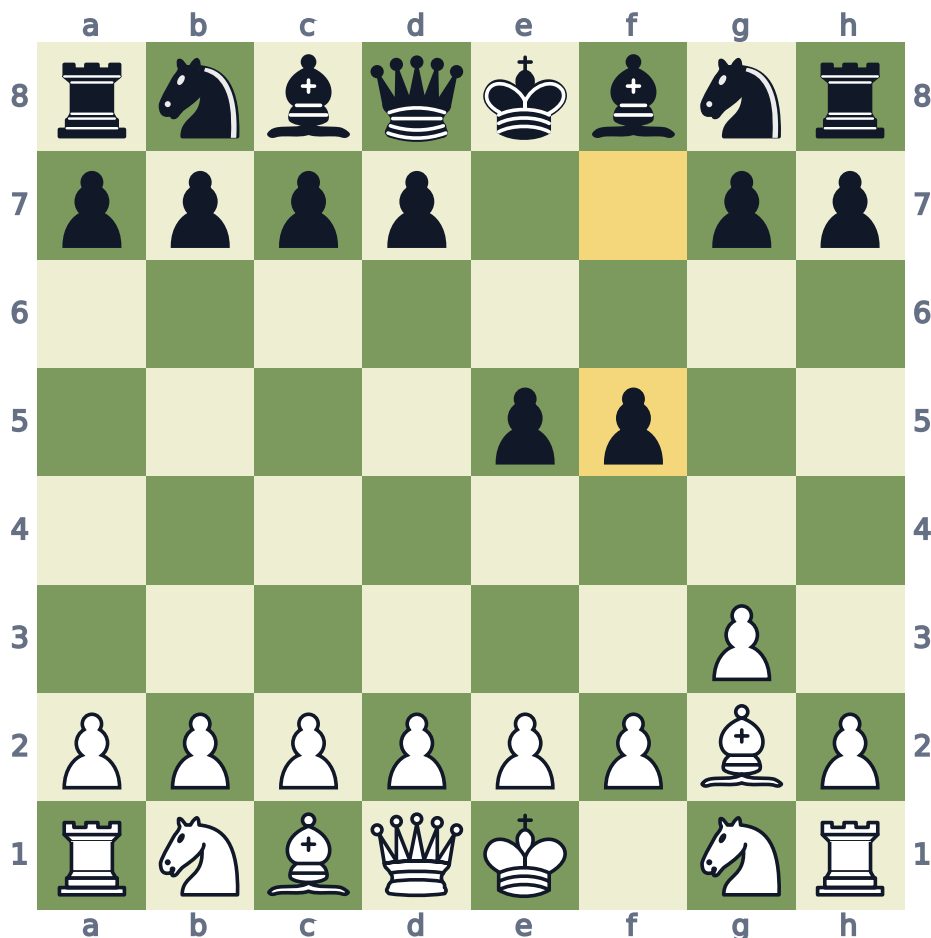
Calculate the opponent's strongest forcing reply before choosing.

STEP 5

At the endpoint, count material and evaluate king safety, development, and center.

TACTICAL TEST 01 OF 36

Early f5 with e4 restraint

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

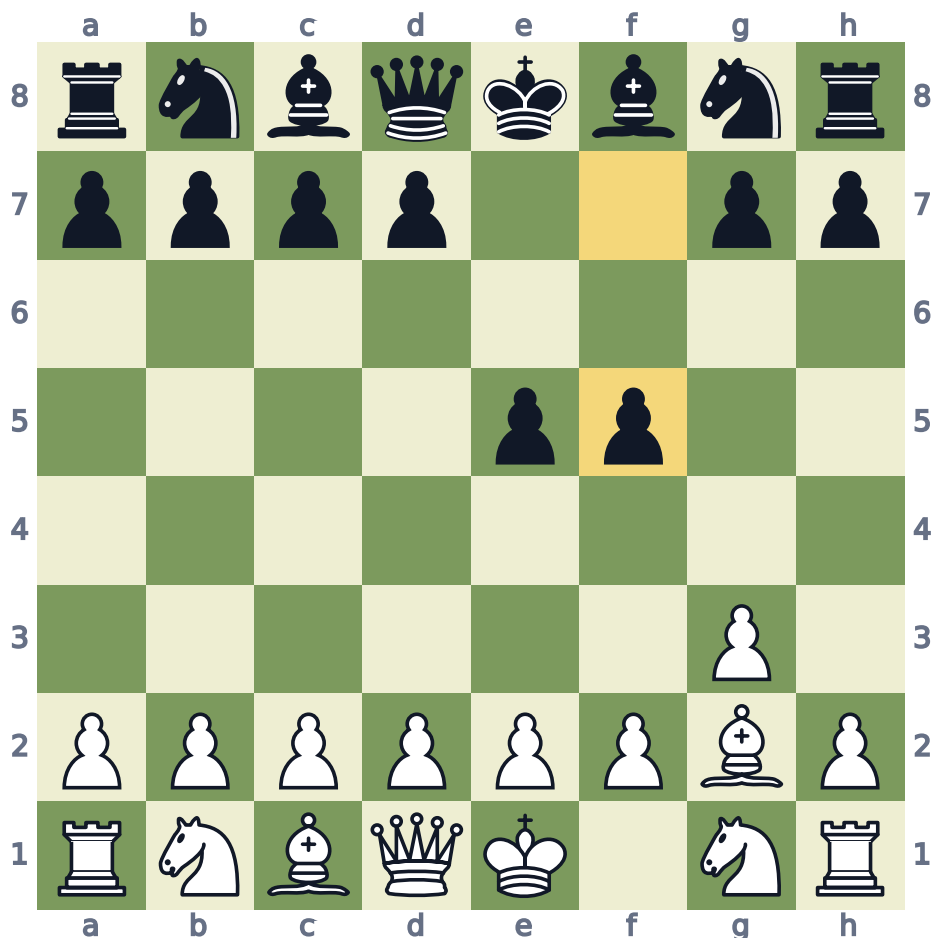
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 02 OF 36

Accept the early f-pawn target



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 03 OF 36

Scandinavian-style immediate d5



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

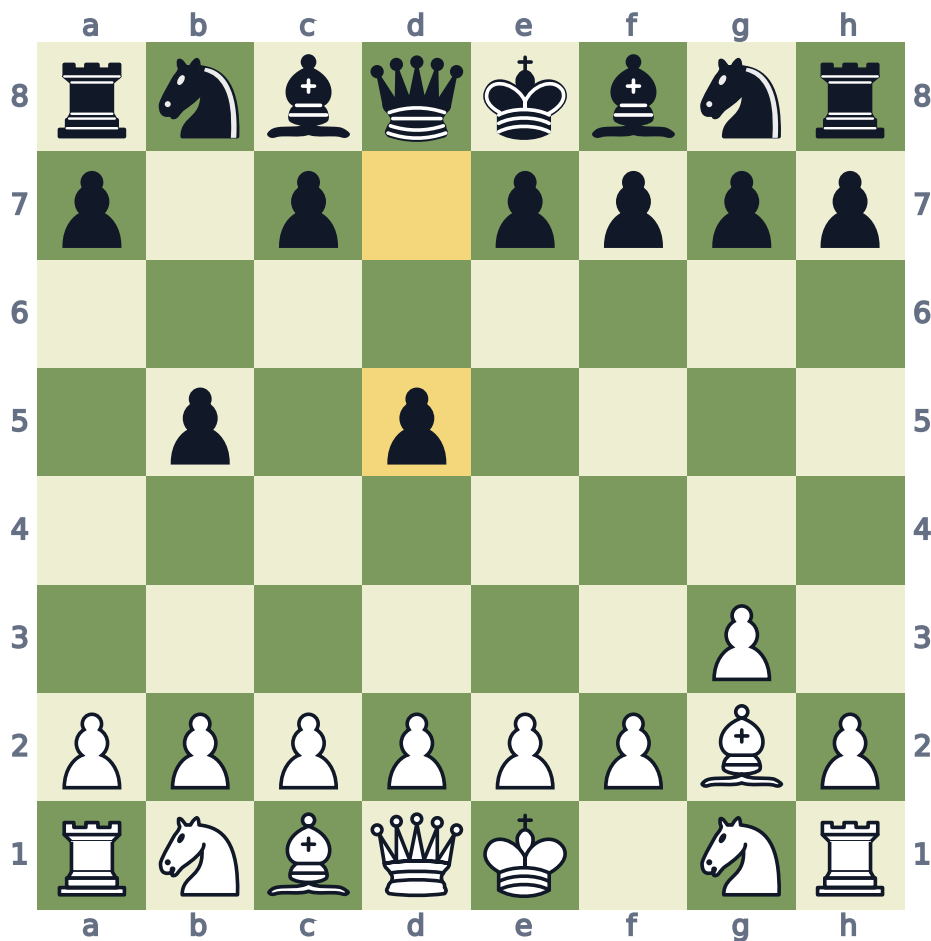
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 04 OF 36

Polish-style b5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

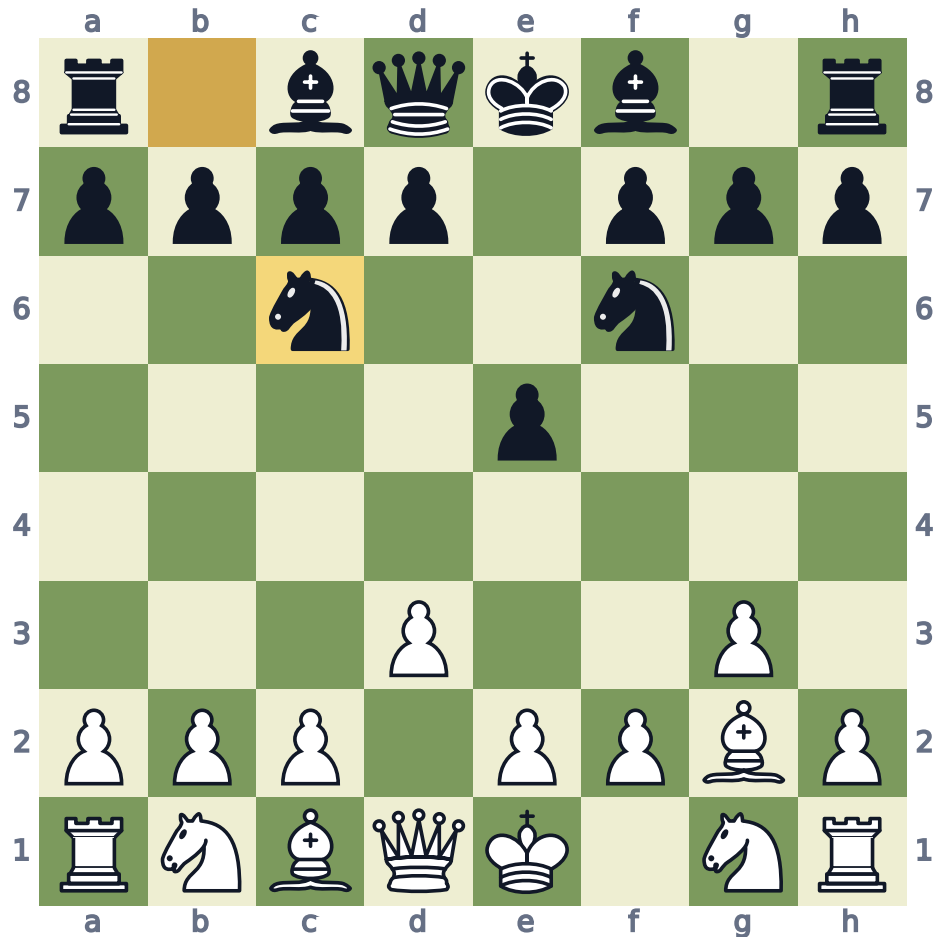
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 05 OF 36

Single e5 with d4 challenge

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

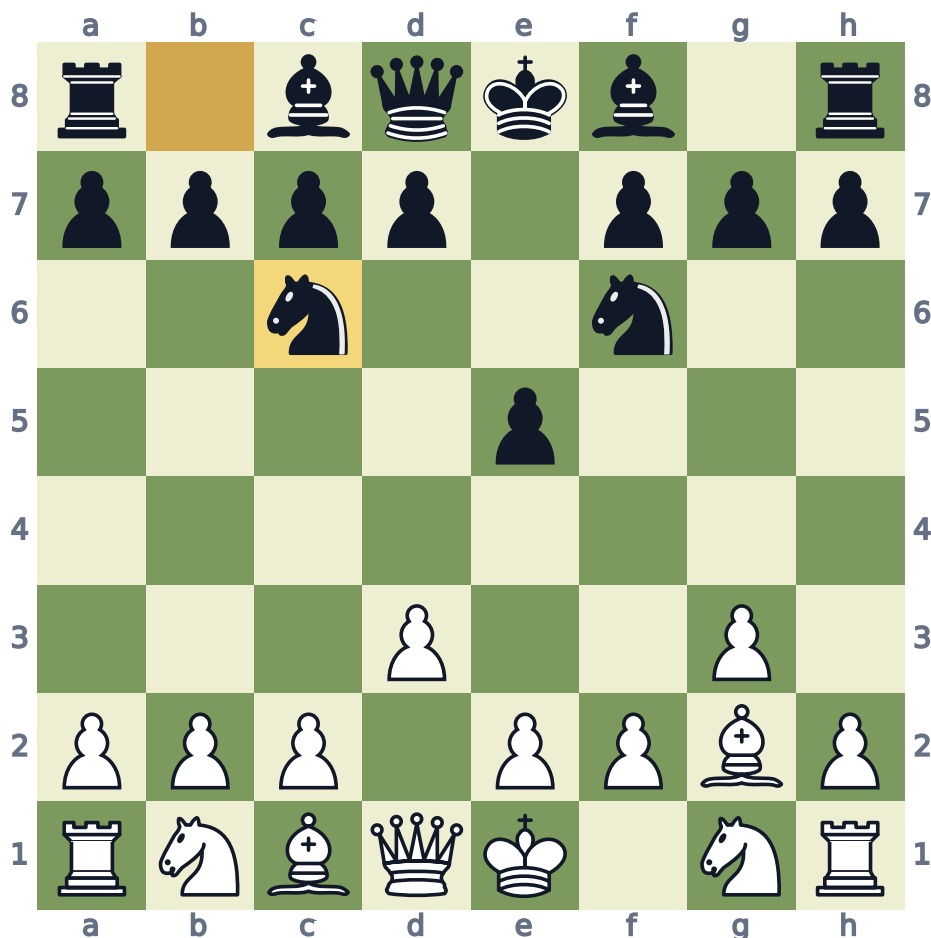
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 06 OF 36

Prepare d4 against e5



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

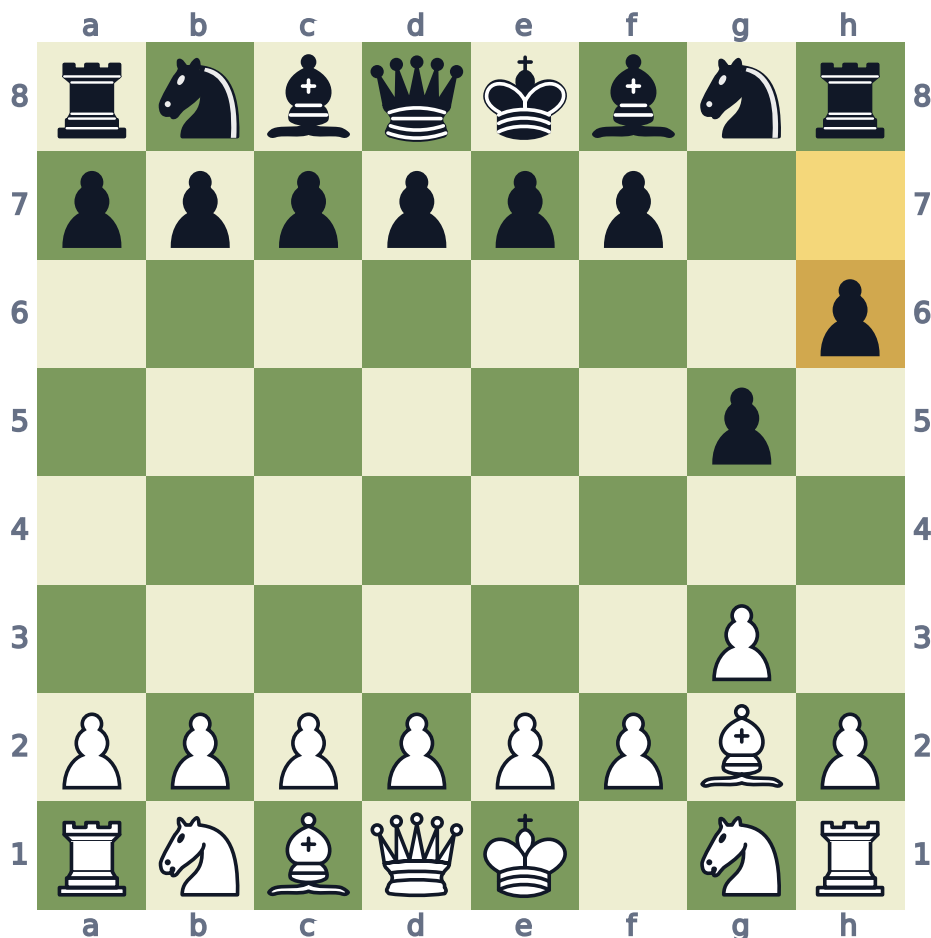
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 07 OF 36

Borg-style g5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

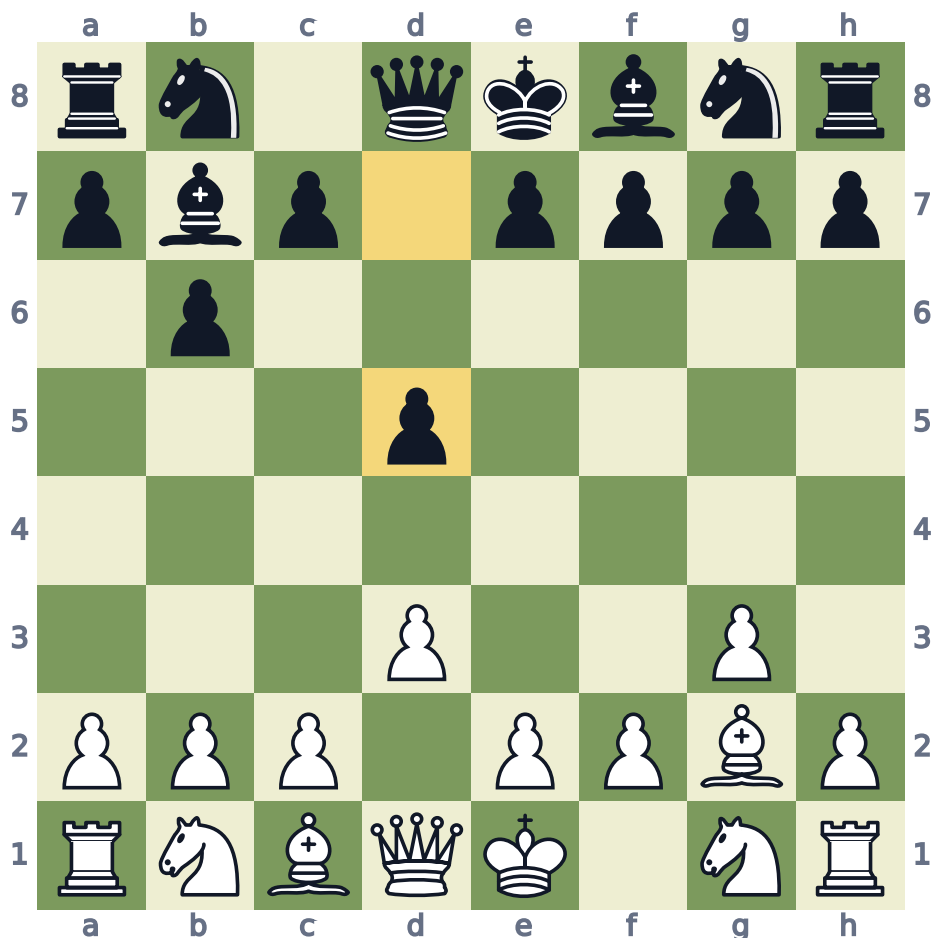
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 08 OF 36

Owen queenside fianchetto

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

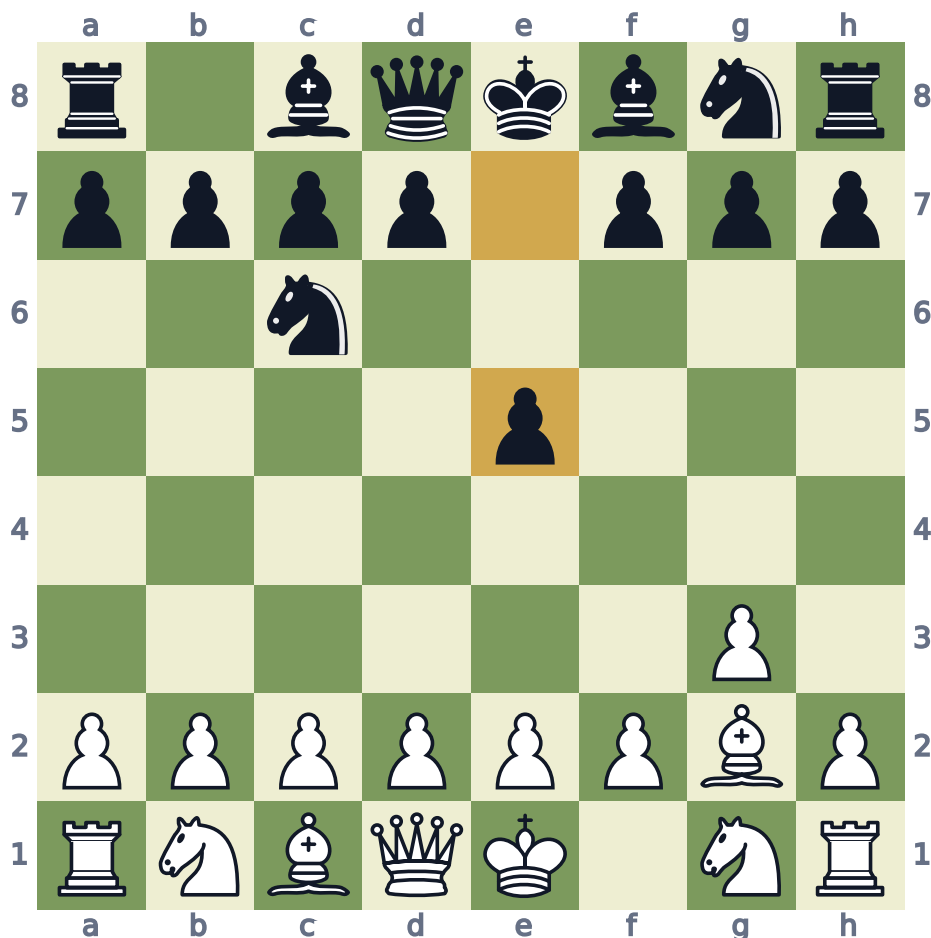
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 09 OF 36

Nimzowitsch-style Nc6

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

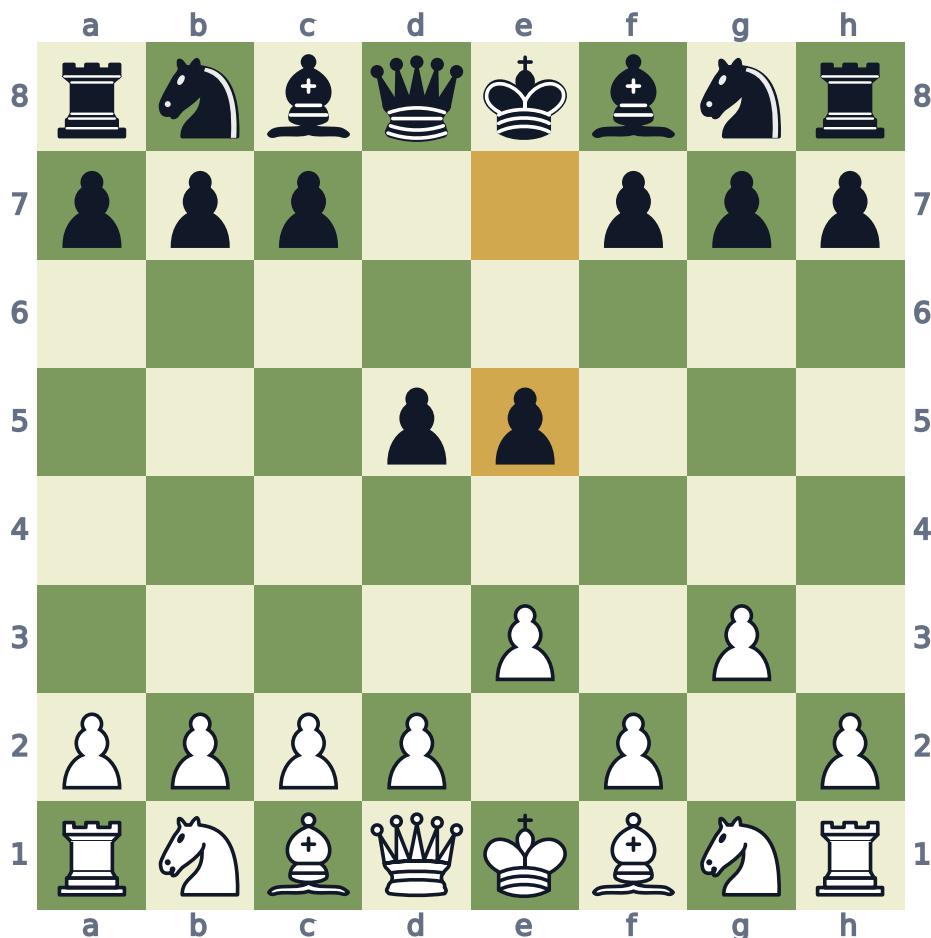
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 10 OF 36

e3-first move order

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 11 OF 36

French shell with e4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

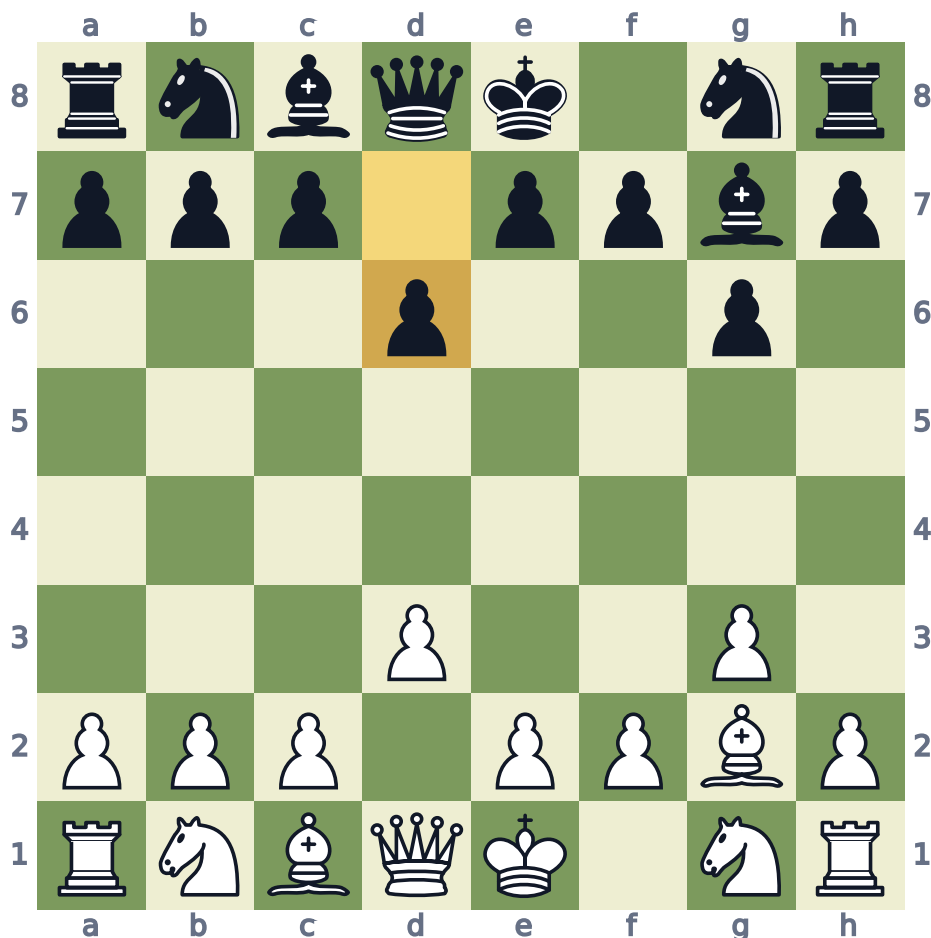
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 12 OF 36

Modern move order

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

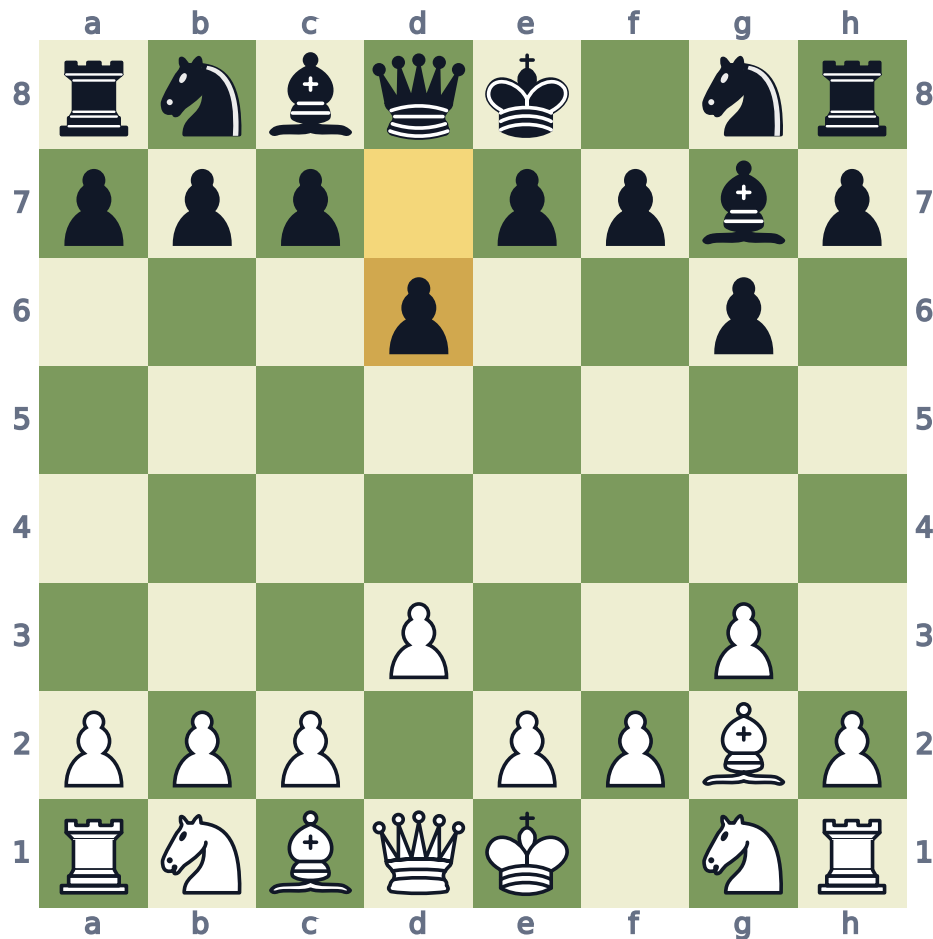
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 13 OF 36

Safe b3 after c3

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 14 OF 36

e4 against a French shell

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

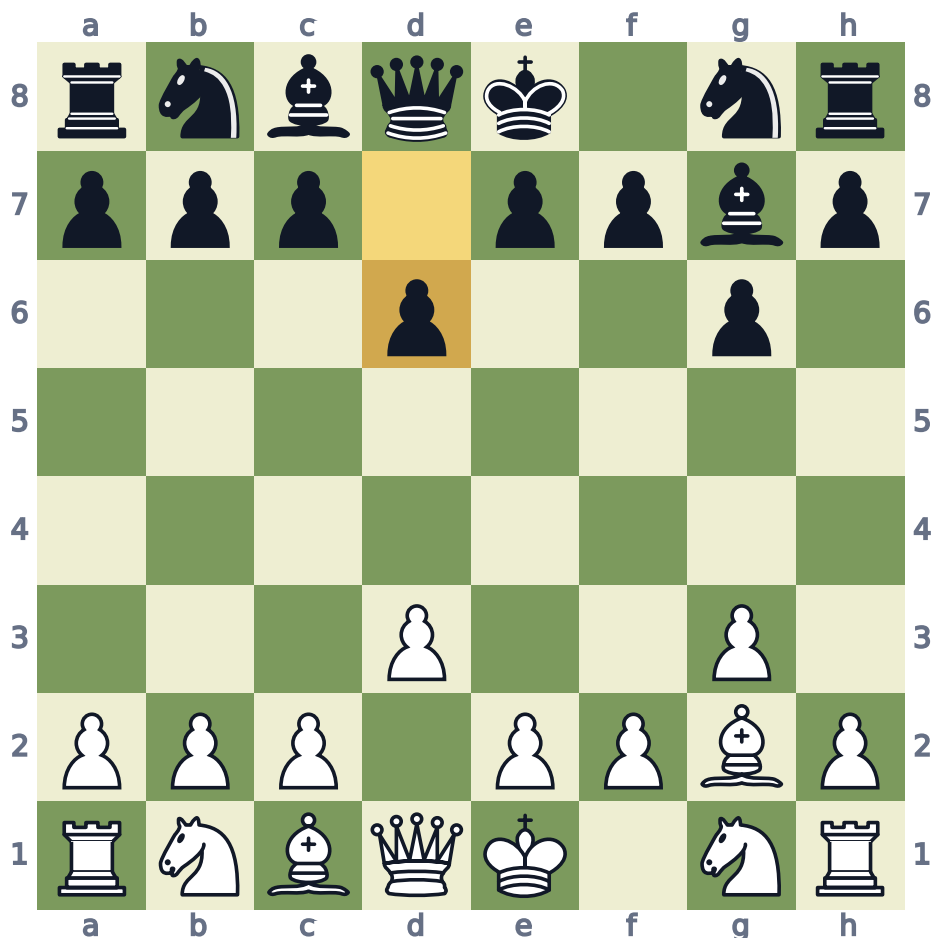
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 15 OF 36

Bb2 after safe preparation

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

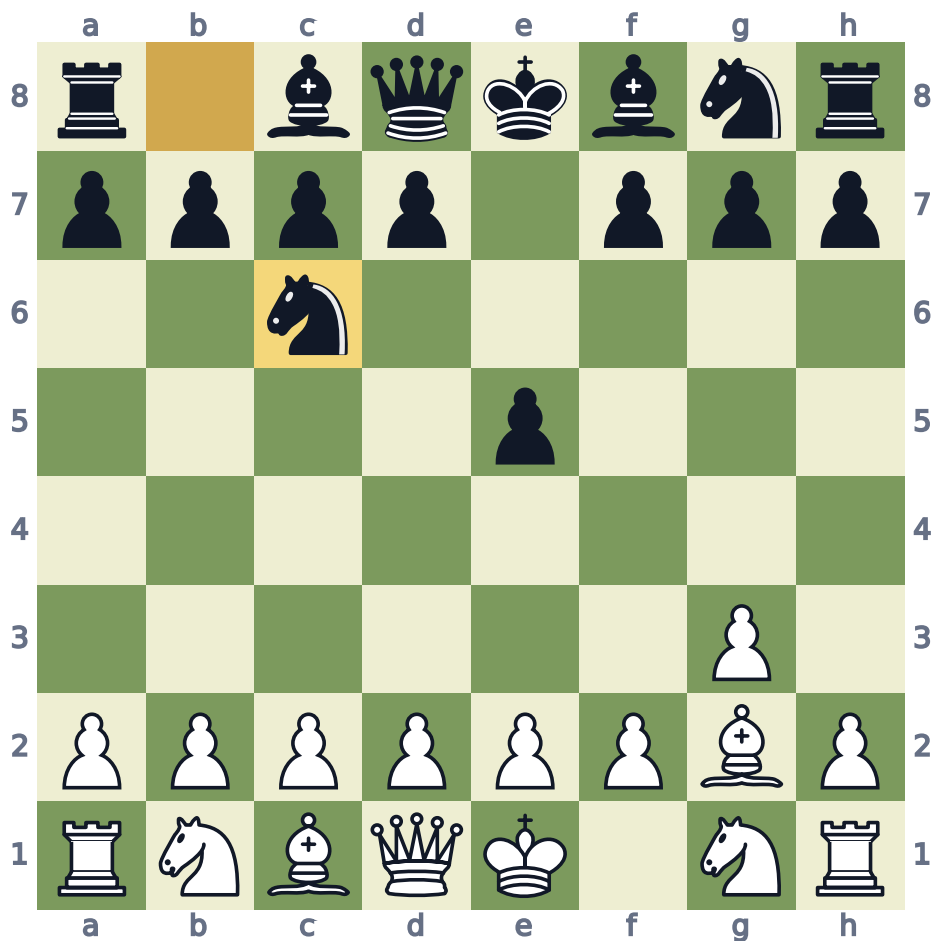
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 16 OF 36

e5 with h5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

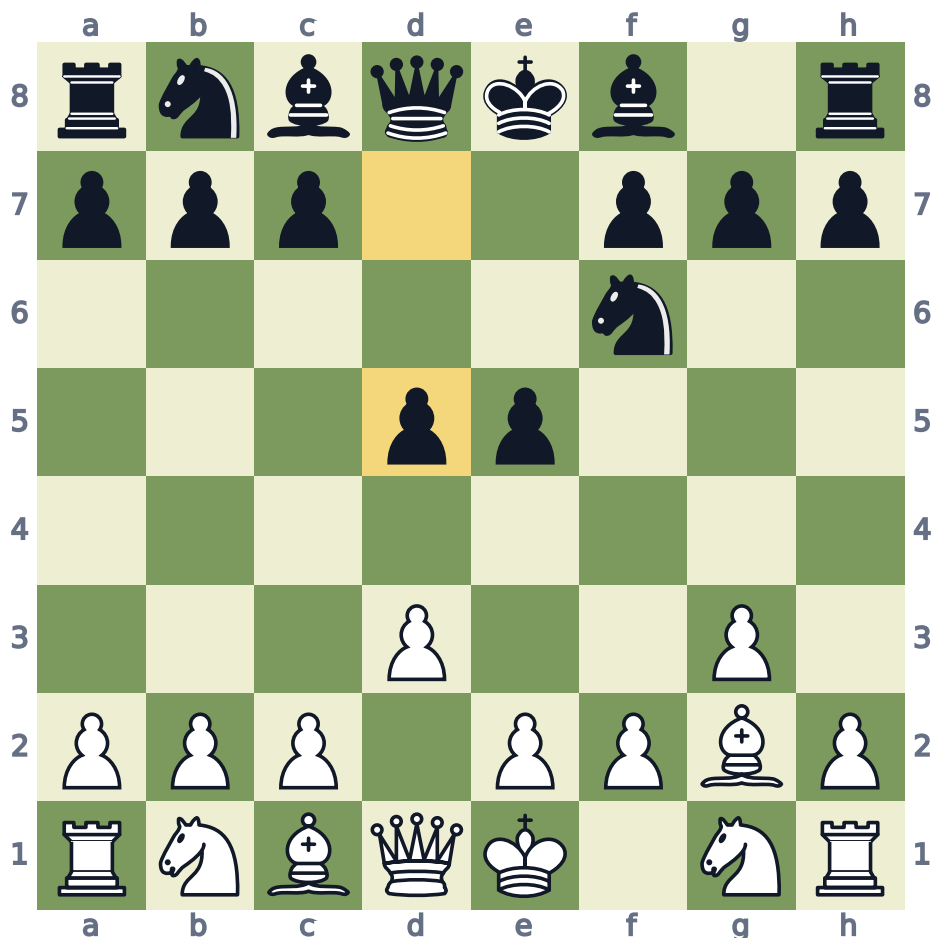
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 17 OF 36

Exit into an open d-file

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

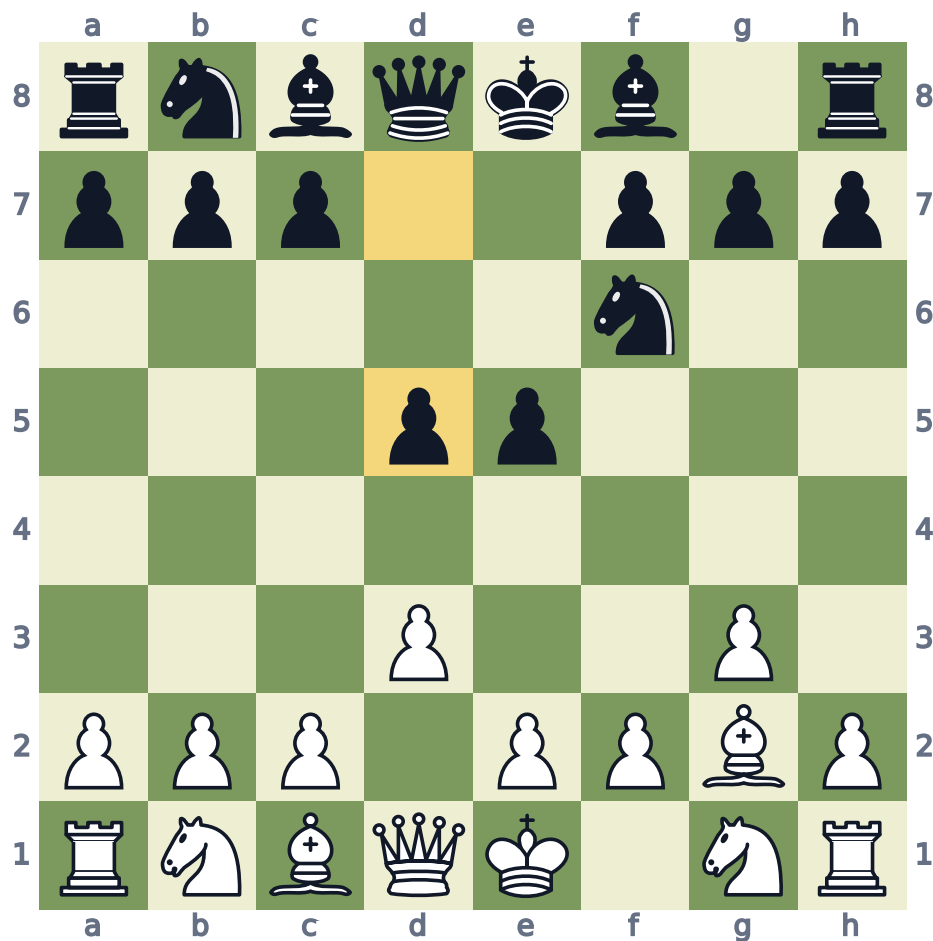
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 18 OF 36

Nd2 to c4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

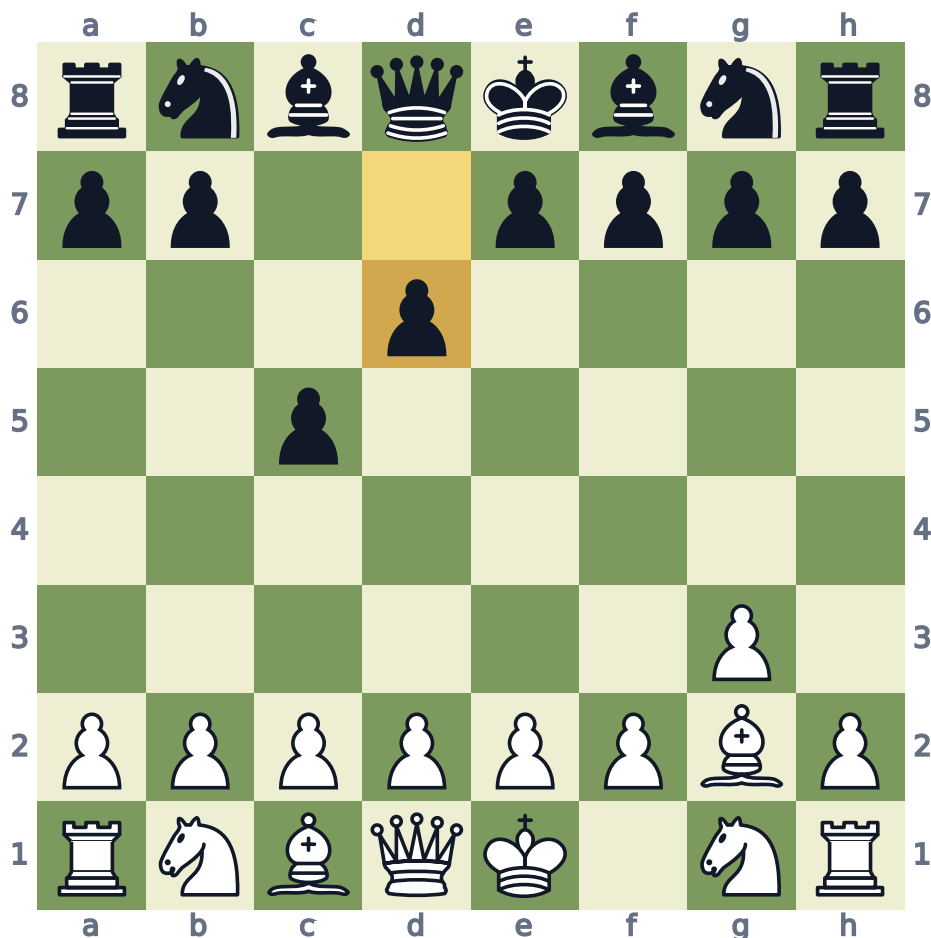
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 19 OF 36

Sicilian with d6 and g6



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

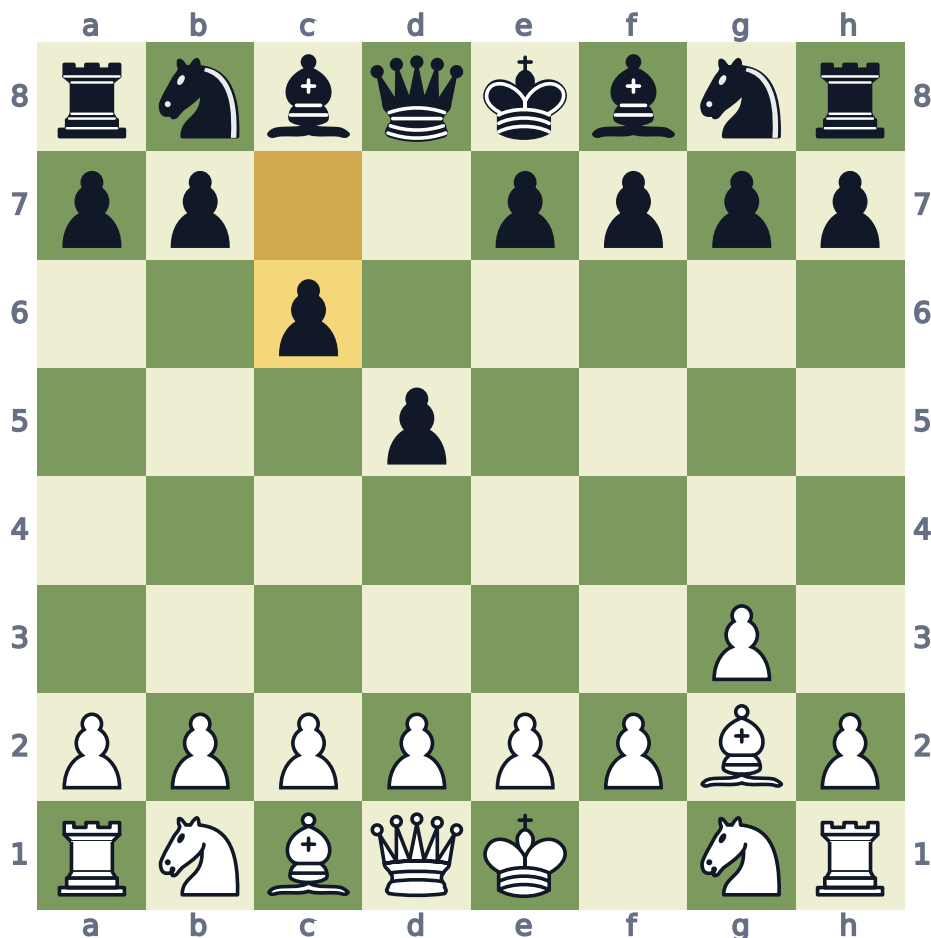
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 20 OF 36

d5-c6 compact shell

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

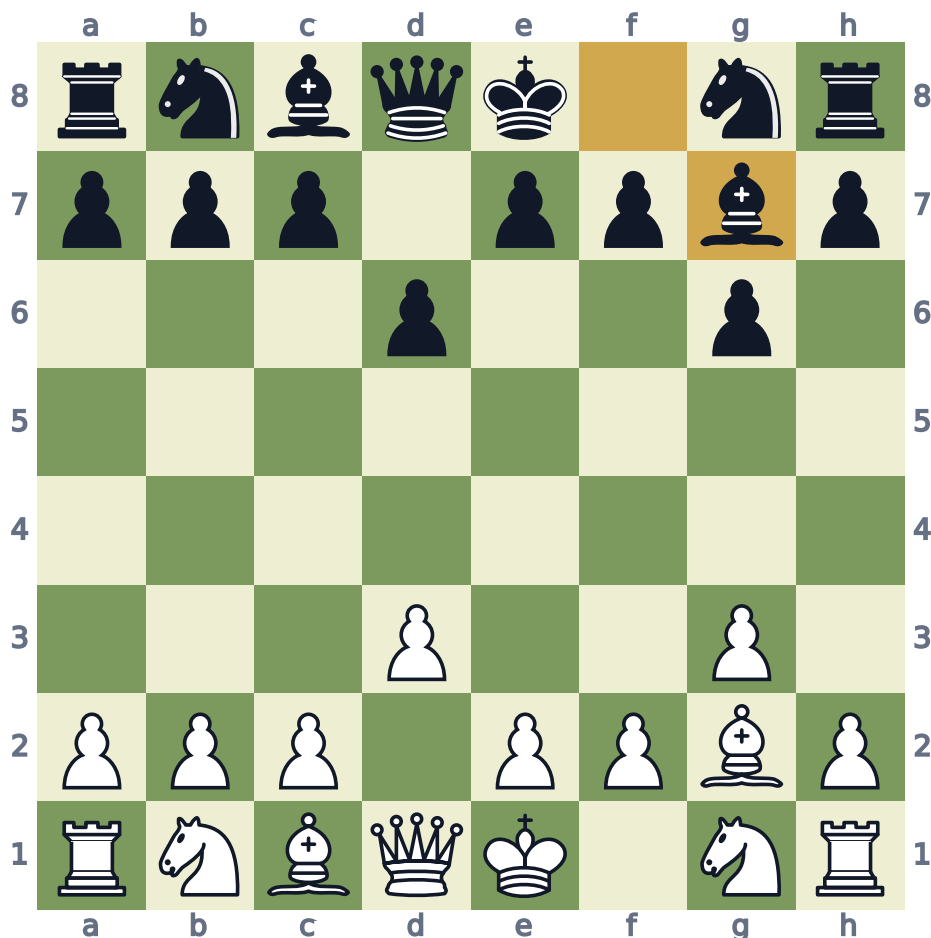
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 21 OF 36

Pirc move order

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

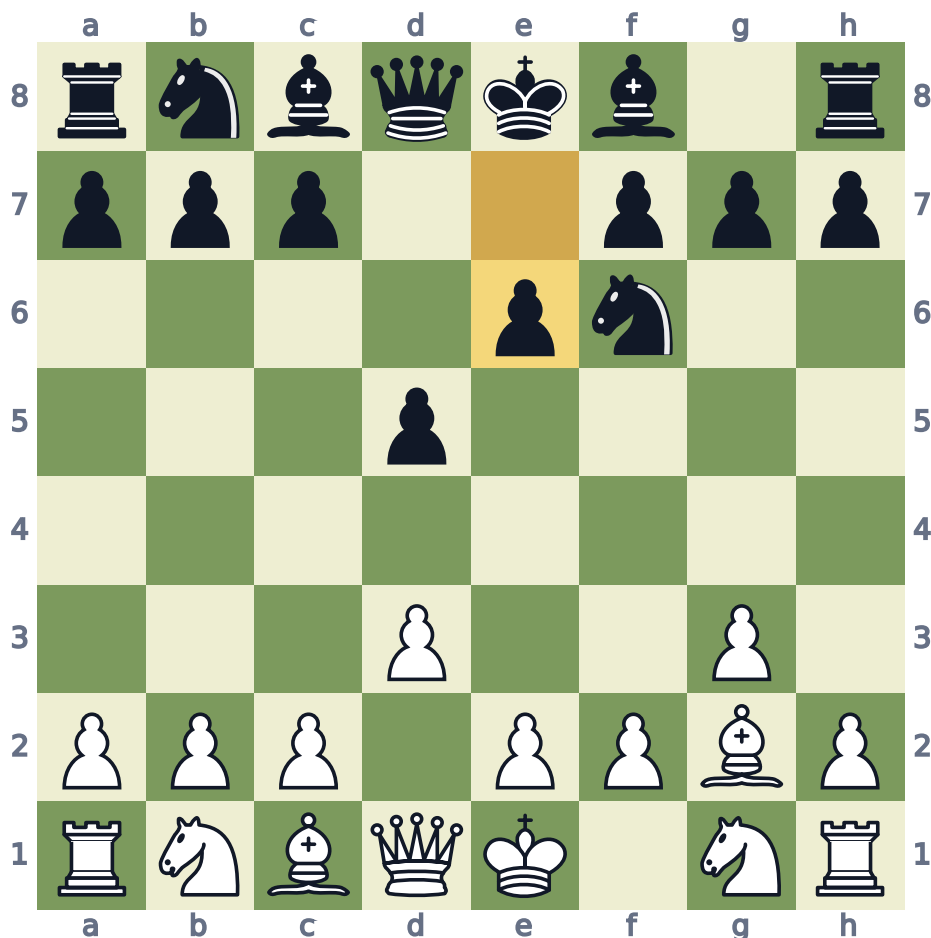
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 22 OF 36

Choose between e4 and d4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

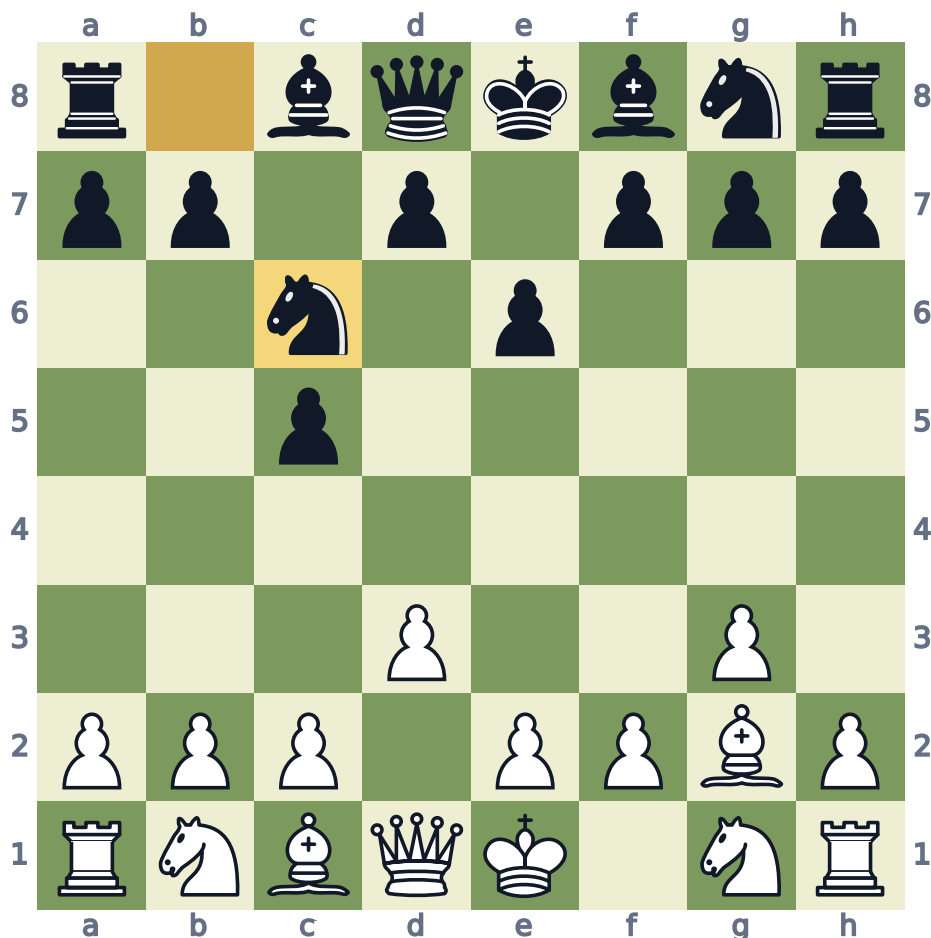
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 23 OF 36

French shell with c4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 24 OF 36

Nf3-first move order

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

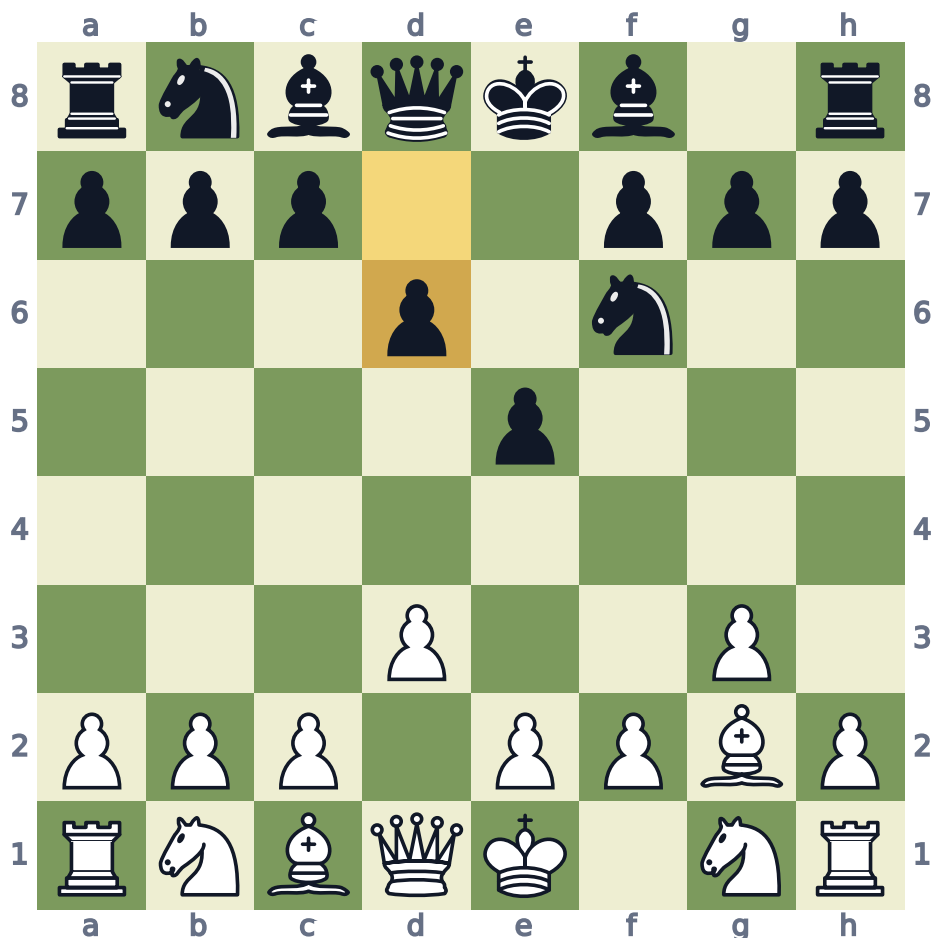
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 25 OF 36

d4 against a single e5 pawn

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

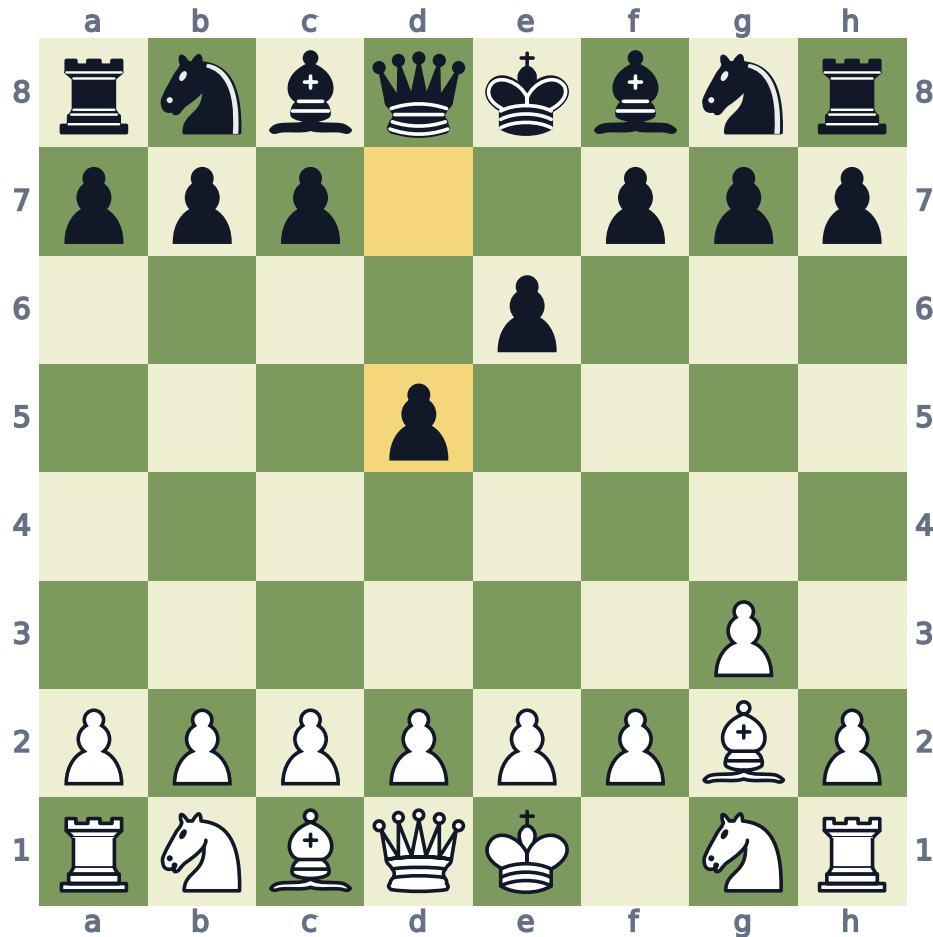
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 26 OF 36

Safe queenside fianchetto order



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 27 OF 36

Early h5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

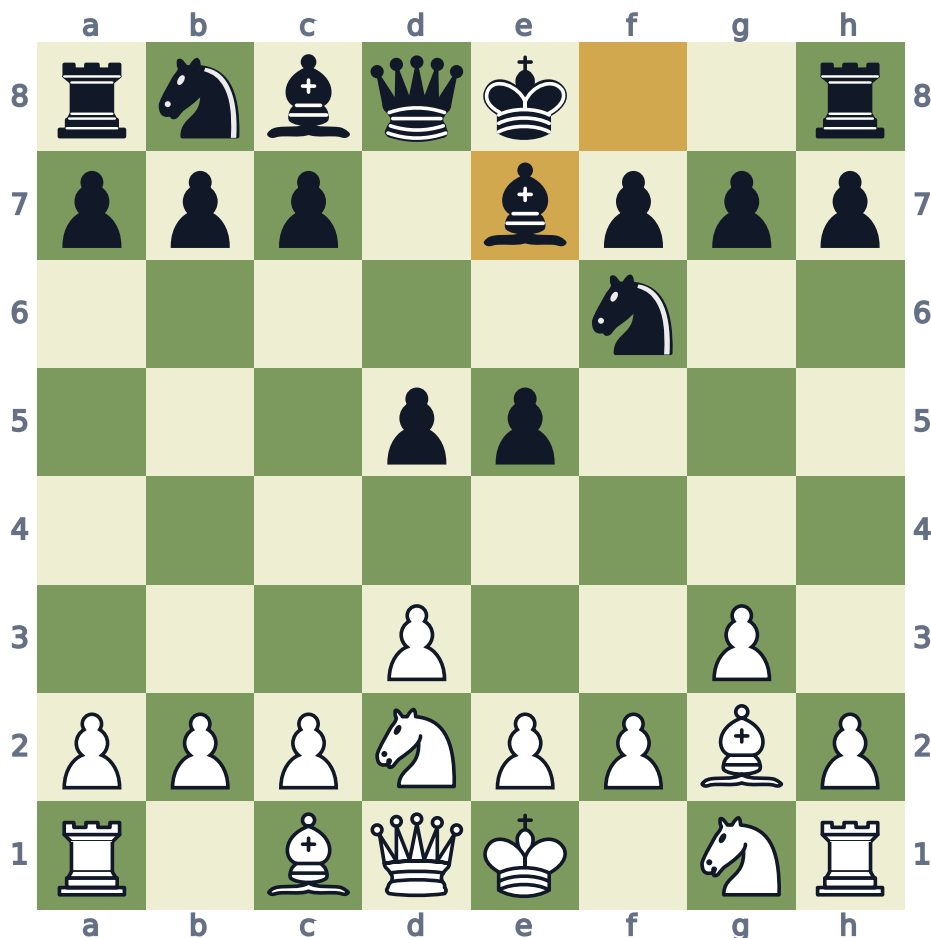
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 28 OF 36

b4 after central stability

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

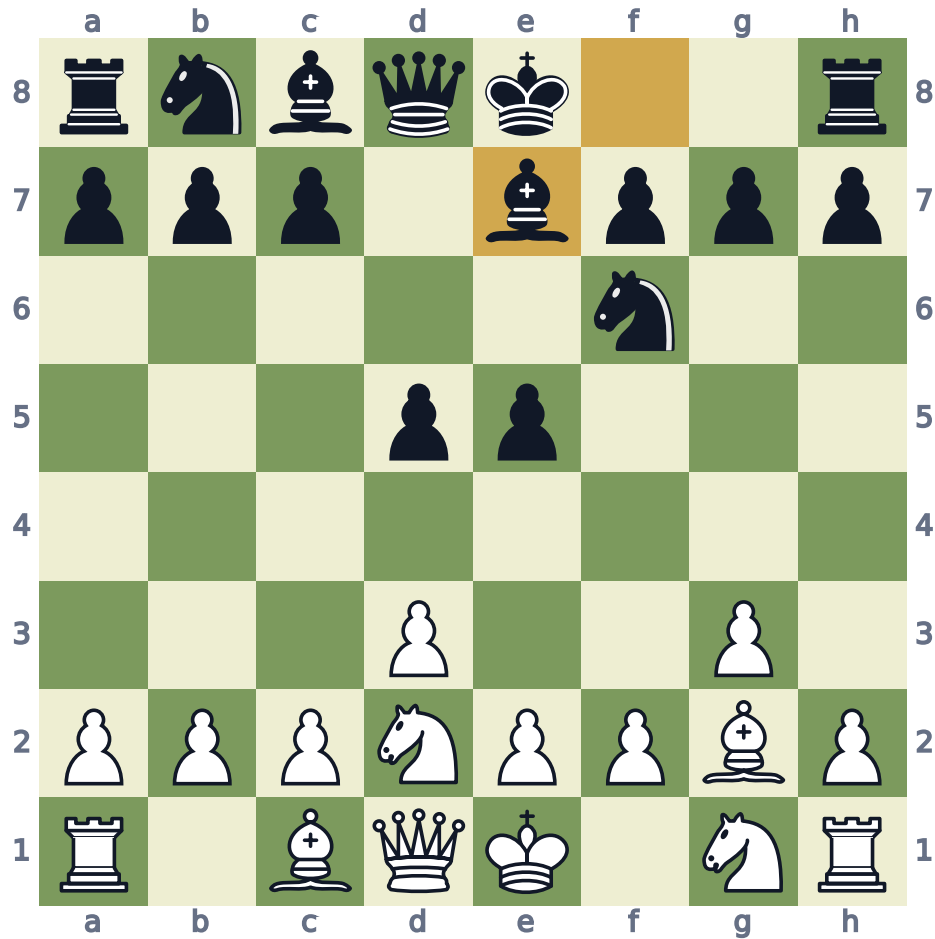
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 29 OF 36

Queen behind e4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 30 OF 36

Black develops Bc5



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 31 OF 36

Meet Bb4 pressure

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

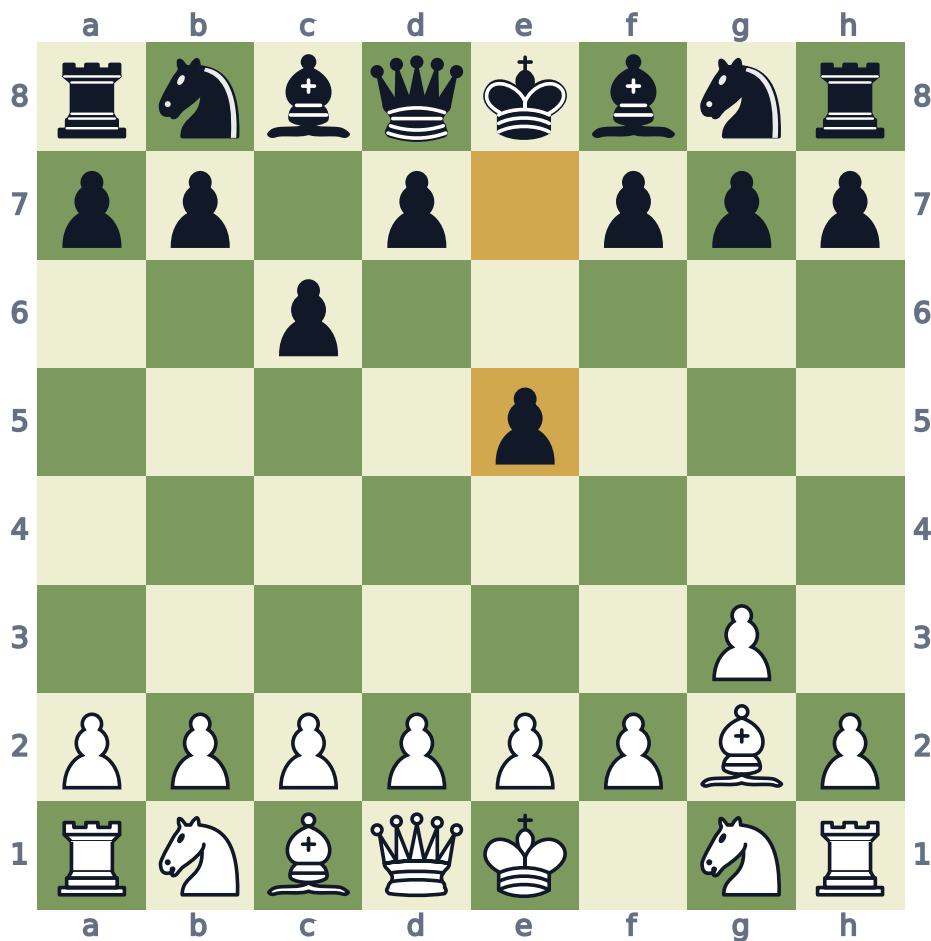
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 32 OF 36

Caro shell with Black e5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

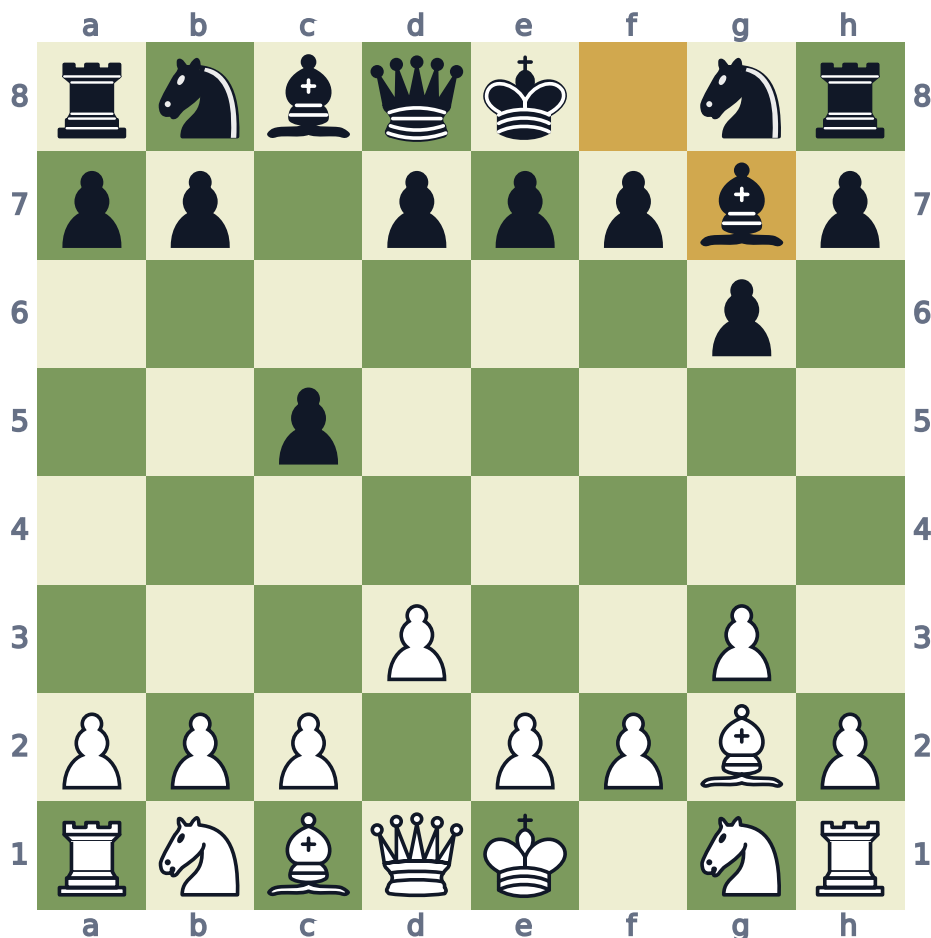
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 33 OF 36

Immediate g6 setup

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 34 OF 36

Mirrored fianchetto with e4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

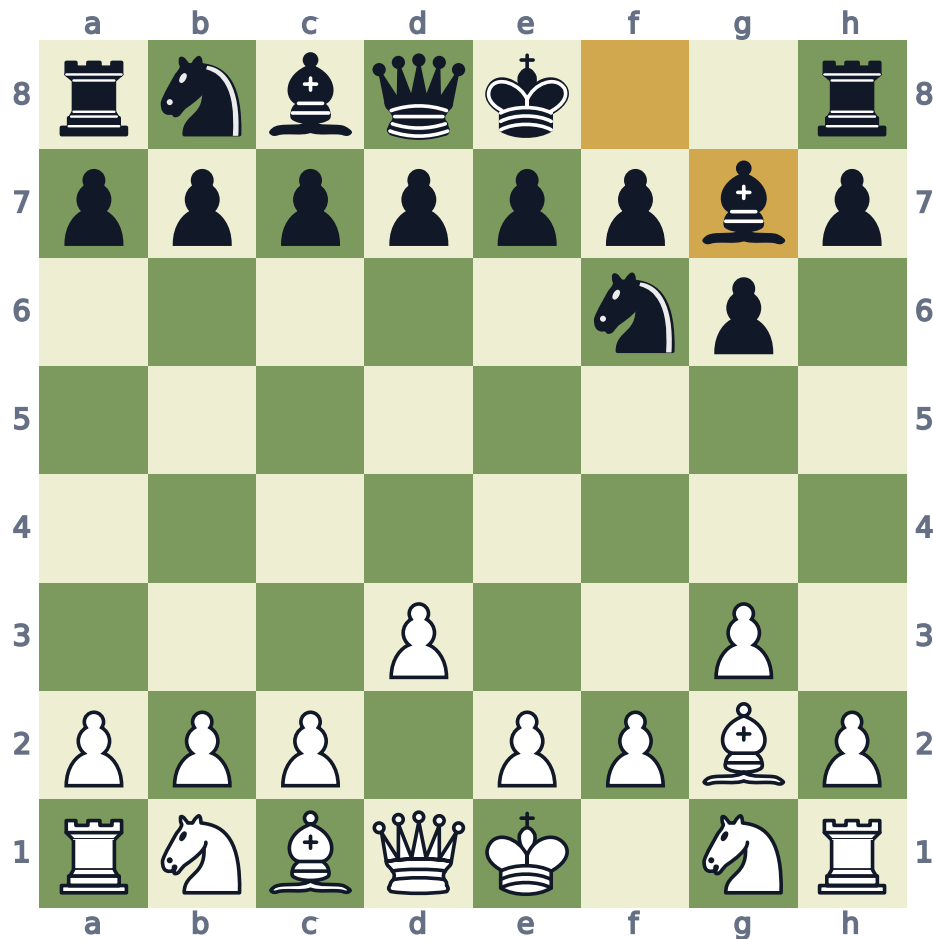
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 35 OF 36

Mirrored fianchetto with c4



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

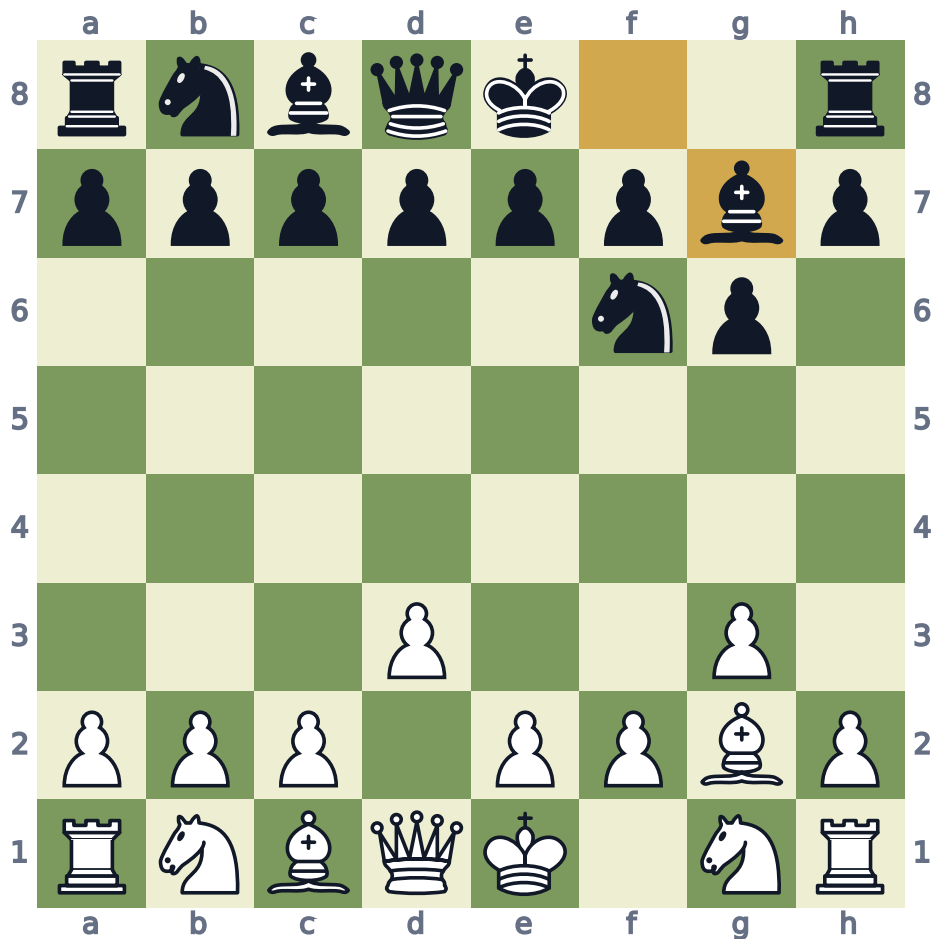
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 36 OF 36

Mirrored fianchetto with d4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Tactical solutions begin here

SCORING HONESTY

A correct first move earns at most 2 points if the line or reason was missing. If the engine move differs from the repertoire move, record why: tactics, transposition, or a small positional preference. The goal is accurate thinking, not worship of a number.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 1-3

01. EARLY F5 WITH E4 RESTRAINT

Engine move: e4. Line: 1. e4 Nc6 2. exf5 Qf6 3. Nc3 Qxf5 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. O-O. Evaluation: +0.75 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use e4 to block the f-pawn's support and prepare f4 or exf5. Warning: fxe4 can open the f-file and central diagonals.

02. ACCEPT THE EARLY F-PAWN TARGET

Engine move: e4. Line: 1. e4 Nc6 2. exf5 Qf6 3. Nc3 Qxf5 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. O-O. Evaluation: +0.75 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Exchange on f5 when it weakens Black's center and gains development targets. Warning: Black may use d5 and Nc6 for quick activity.

03. SCANDINAVIAN-STYLE IMMEDIATE D5

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 g6 2. c4 c6 3. b3 Bg7 4. Bb2 Bg4 5. d4 Nbd7. Evaluation: +0.31 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Prepare e4 or c4 while Black's center is still modest. Warning: d4 can close the position on Black's terms.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 4-6

04. POLISH-STYLE B5

Engine move: e4. Line: 1. e4 dxe4 2. Bxe4 c6 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. d4 Bb7 5. Nf3 e6. Evaluation: +0.74 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Build the center and later attack b5 with a4. Warning: b4 can gain space and restrict c3.

05. SINGLE E5 WITH D4 CHALLENGE

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nc3 Be6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. O-O O-O. Evaluation: +0.01 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Prepare d4 and develop rapidly against a single central pawn. Warning: e4 can gain space if White delays.

06. PREPARE D4 AGAINST E5

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nc3 Be6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. O-O O-O. Evaluation: +0.01 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Challenge e5 and open the center when White is fully developed. Warning: e4 can close the position and begin a kingside plan.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 7-9

07. BORG-STYLE G5

Engine move: h4. Line: 1. h4 Bg7 2. d4 g4 3. e4 d6 4. Nc3 Nc6 5. Be3. Evaluation: +1.16 for White (White is clearly better). Positional purpose: Claim e4 and develop while Black weakens the kingside. Warning: g4 can gain space and attack White's f3 square.

08. OWEN QUEENSIDE FIANCHETTO

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 Nf6 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. d4 e6 4. e4 Nf6. Evaluation: +0.35 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use d5 to block the long diagonal and prepare e4 or c4. Warning: c5 may attack the center before White is ready.

09. NIMZOWITSCH-STYLE NC6

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 Bb4 3. Nf3 O-O 4. O-O Re8 5. Nd5 e4. Evaluation: +0.27 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Prepare e4 or c4 while Black commits the knight in front of the c-pawn. Warning: e4 can gain space and attack Nd2's routes.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 10-12

10. E3-FIRST MOVE ORDER

Engine move: d4. Line: 1. d4 Nc6 2. dxe5 Nxe5 3. Nd2 Bd6 4. Ngf3 Nf6 5. Nxe5 Bxe5. Evaluation: -0.56 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use e3 to support d4 and free the queen bishop before fianchettoing. Warning: e4 can gain space before White completes development.

11. FRENCH SHELL WITH E4

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O a5 3. c4 O-O 4. Bf4 h6 5. Re1. Evaluation: +0.01 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Attack d5 and transpose toward a King's Indian Attack structure. Warning: d4 can gain space and close the g2 bishop.

12. MODERN MOVE ORDER

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 c5 2. e3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Nge2 Rb8 5. Rb1 O-O. Evaluation: +0.24 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use the extra tempo to occupy e4 before Black chooses f5 or c5. Warning: f5 can begin immediately after castling.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 13-15

13. SAFE B3 AFTER C3

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 c5 2. e3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Nge2 Rb8 5. Rb1 O-O. Evaluation: +0.24 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Close the g7-a1 diagonal with c3 before playing b3. Warning: d5 can still gain central space.

14. E4 AGAINST A FRENCH SHELL

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O a5 3. c4 O-O 4. Bf4 h6 5. Re1. Evaluation: +0.01 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Challenge d5 and enter a King's Indian Attack structure. Warning: d4 can gain space and make c4 necessary later.

15. BB2 AFTER SAFE PREPARATION

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 c5 2. e3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Nge2 Rb8 5. Rb1 O-O. Evaluation: +0.24 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Activate the queen bishop only after c3 closes the a1 diagonal. Warning: d5 can close the bishop's line immediately.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 16-18

16. E5 WITH H5

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 Bb4 3. Nf3 O-O 4. O-O Re8 5. d3 Bxc3. Evaluation: +0.25 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Castle and meet the wing pawn with development and central play. Warning: h4 can cramp the kingside or provoke a weakening capture.

17. EXIT INTO AN OPEN D-FILE

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. O-O O-O 3. c4 c6 4. cxd5 cxd5 5. Bg5 Be6. Evaluation: -0.23 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Open the center when exchanges improve development and expose Black's center. Warning: exd4 can leave White with an isolated or backward pawn.

18. ND2 TO C4

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. O-O O-O 3. c4 c6 4. cxd5 cxd5 5. Bg5 Be6. Evaluation: -0.23 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use b3 as a route toward c5 and d4 after the center closes. Warning: b5 can chase the knight and gain queenside space.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 19-21

19. SICILIAN WITH D6 AND G6

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 g6 2. d4 cxd4 3. Nxd4 Bg7 4. O-O Nf6 5. c4. Evaluation: +0.52 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Keep the center flexible and prepare e4 or c3-d4. Warning: Black may play e5 or h5 before White acts.

20. D5-C6 COMPACT SHELL

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 g6 2. O-O Bg7 3. d4 Nf6 4. b3 Bf5 5. Bb2 O-O. Evaluation: +0.22 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use e4 to force central clarification and open development lines. Warning: Bg4 can pin the queen or knight after exchanges.

21. PIRC MOVE ORDER

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 c5 2. e3 e6 3. Nc3 Ne7 4. Nge2 O-O 5. O-O Nbc6. Evaluation: +0.21 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Reach a stable e4 structure and prepare f4 or d4. Warning: d5 can gain space and close the diagonal.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 22-24

22. CHOOSE BETWEEN E4 AND D4

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O O-O 3. Nc3 c5 4. e4 Nc6 5. e5 Nd7. Evaluation: +0.08 for White (equal).
Positional purpose: Use d4 when Black's e-pawn does not occupy e5 and central symmetry is acceptable. Warning: cxd4 can create an isolated pawn or open c-file pressure.

23. FRENCH SHELL WITH C4

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 d5 2. O-O Bd6 3. c4 d4 4. e3 e5 5. exd4 cxd4. Evaluation: +0.17 for White (equal).
Positional purpose: Use e4 and c4 pressure to prevent a free classical center. Warning: d4 can create a Benoni-like space bind.

24. NF3-FIRST MOVE ORDER

Engine move: Bg2. Line: 1. Bg2 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. c4 c6 4. b3 O-O 5. Bb2. Evaluation: +0.24 for White (White is slightly better).
Positional purpose: Use Nf3 to restrain e5, then enter a White-Hippo shell with faster castling.
Warning: The knight blocks f4 and changes some attacking plans.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 25-27

25. D4 AGAINST A SINGLE E5 PAWN

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. b4 O-O 4. a4 c6 5. Nf3 Re8. Evaluation: +0.39 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Take central space and free the c1 bishop before Black plays d5. Warning: e4 can close the position and attack the kingside.

26. SAFE QUEENSIDE FIANCHETTO ORDER

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d4 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. O-O c5 4. e3 Nc6 5. d3 Be7. Evaluation: +0.46 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use d5 to block the a8 diagonal before Black plays b6 and Bb7. Warning: dxe4 can open the bishop with tempo.

27. EARLY H5

Engine move: Nc3. Line: 1. Nc3 c6 2. d4 d5. Evaluation: +0.12 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Counter the wing advance with central occupation and development. Warning: hxg3 can damage the kingside structure.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 28-30

28. B4 AFTER CENTRAL STABILITY

Engine move: Ngf3. Line: 1. Ngf3 Nc6 2. O-O a5 3. c3 a4 4. Qc2 O-O 5. e4 d4. Evaluation: -0.38 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Gain queenside space after a3 and castling make the expansion more secure. Warning: a5 can challenge the pawn chain on the next move.

29. QUEEN BEHIND E4

Engine move: Ngf3. Line: 1. Ngf3 Nc6 2. O-O a5 3. c3 a4 4. Qc2 O-O 5. e4 d4. Evaluation: -0.38 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use Qd2 to connect rooks and support e4 after the knight clears the file. Warning: d4 can attack the queen's future route and close Bb2.

30. BLACK DEVELOPS BC5

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. O-O Nb6 5. Nc3 Be7. Evaluation: +0.22 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Prepare d4 without exposing the king to a central tactic. Warning: Ng4 and d4 can create pressure before White castles.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 31-33

31. MEET BB4 PRESSURE

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. O-O Nb6 5. Nc3 Be7. Evaluation: +0.22 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Question the bishop and build e4 without allowing a damaging pin. Warning: d4 can gain space after c3 blocks the knight.

32. CARO SHELL WITH BLACK E5

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 e4 2. Nd4 d5 3. d3 exd3 4. Qxd3 Bc5 5. Nb3 Bb6. Evaluation: +0.31 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Prepare e4 or c4 against Black's full center. Warning: e4 can gain space and restrict Nd2.

33. IMMEDIATE G6 SETUP

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 e6 2. Nc3 Ne7 3. e4 d6 4. Nge2 Nbc6 5. Be3. Evaluation: +0.12 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Prepare c3 and d4 while controlling the long diagonal. Warning: d5 can arrive in one move and equalize.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 34-36

34. MIRRORED FIANCHETTO WITH E4

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5. Evaluation: +0.10 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Use the extra tempo to claim e4 and prepare f4 or d4. Warning: f5 can create a fast kingside attack.

35. MIRRORED FIANCHETTO WITH C4

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5. Evaluation: +0.10 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Control d5 and prepare a Botvinnik or English structure. Warning: c6 and d5 can challenge the queenside bind.

36. MIRRORED FIANCHETTO WITH D4

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5. Evaluation: +0.10 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Challenge e5 and clarify the center before Black starts f5. Warning: e4 can close the center and gain kingside space.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.